Law at the Edge of Transformation

A Conversation with Dr. Shardul S. Shroff, Executive Chairman, Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas & Co



Dr. Shardul S. Shroff
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Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas & Co. (SAM), founded on a century of legal achievements, is one of India's leading full-service law firms with the ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification - the latest global benchmark for Information Security Management Systems. The Firm's mission is to enable business by providing solutions as trusted advisers through excellence, responsiveness, innovation, and collaboration. SAM is known globally for its exceptional practices in mergers & acquisitions, private equity, competition law, insolvency & restructuring, dispute resolution, international commercial arbitration, capital markets, banking & finance, tax, intellectual property, data protection and data privacy, white collar crime, technology law and infrastructure, energy and project finance. With the full suite of Harvey AI functionalities, the Firm has a pan-India presence and has been at the helm of major headline transactions and litigations in all sectors, besides advising major multinational corporates on their entry into the Indian market and their business strategy. Currently, the Firm has around 1,000 lawyers including 190 Partners, offering legal services through its offices in New Delhi, Mumbai, Gurugram, Ahmedabad, GIFT City(Gandhinagar), Kolkata, Bengaluru and Chennai.

The firm is regarded as one of India's leading full-service law firm. How does that integrated capability become a decisive advantage as the legal landscape grows more complex?

The complexity clients navigate today is rarely confined to a single domain. A transaction, a regulatory filing, or a business pivot can simultaneously trigger corporate, tax, employment, IP, ESG, and now AI-related legal considerations. What clients need is not a sequence of disconnected opinions but a unified, integrated counsel that holds the whole picture and moves as one. That has always been our defining strength: the depth to go deep in every practice, and the cohesion to bring it together seamlessly for the client. As the pace of change accelerates, that integrated value is more consequential than ever.

AI is now central to boardroom decision-making. What should leadership be prioritising?

AI is making governance more data-driven and genuinely forward-looking, particularly in risk assessment, compliance, and long-range strategy. But boards must be clear-eyed about one fundamental point: AI enhances the